

English Ladder

Teaching Guide

Describing Trends

A concise classroom guide with lesson flow, teaching cues, and a ready-to-use answer key built around the same English Ladder concept sheet.



Grammar Concepts #43

Key Points

Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **Describing Trends** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

ENGLISH LADDER

Concept #43 ▶ **Describing Trends**

 Trends are movements over time. The arrows on the right show many of the terms we use to describe trends. The **black terms** are both nouns or verbs. The **red and green terms** are adjectives (matching nouns) that can be converted into adverbs (matching verbs). Consider the examples below.

- The **sharp increase** in sales was surprising. **adjective + noun**
- Sales **sharply increased** last month. **adverb + verb**
- Recently there has been a **slight fall** in sales. **adjective + noun**
- Sales **have fallen slightly** this year. **verb + adverb**

Adverbs are flexible and can go either before or after the verb.

Trend Progression Example
(Trend terms are underlined.)

For most of 2020, there were relatively few COVID-19 cases in Japan. However, there was a surge in cases near the beginning of 2021 to about 6k, lasting about two months. Due to a ban on in-bound travellers, cases dramatically fell. However, there was another sharp rise in cases that peaked in May of 2021, reaching the level of January's high. But, once again, cases dropped steeply in June. However, during the Tokyo Olympics, the number of cases dramatically rose to nearly 24k by the middle of September. Cases sharply decreased a month later to reach nearly zero by December of 2021.

Other Terms

- Sales were **stable**. (good news)
- Sales were **flat**. (bad news)
- Sales have been **fluctuating**.
- Sales **recovered**.





At a Glance

Lesson focus Describing Trends	Suggested timing 45-60 minutes
Core objective Students explain the target pattern clearly and apply it accurately in controlled practice and discussion.	Materials Student PDF, the concept image, board space, and time for partner checking.

Suggested Lesson Flow

Warm-up	Display the concept image and ask learners to predict the rule behind Describing Trends before reading the explanation.
Model	Walk through the Core Idea and the sections on Key Points. Pause after each part so students can restate the pattern in plain English.
Guided practice	Project two or three examples from the concept sheet and ask pairs to explain why each choice works, not just what the answer is.
Independent work	Assign the 24 practice items for quiet work, partner checking, and final feedback.
Closure	Ask students to create one new sentence or mini-example of their own that follows the same pattern.



Likely Learner Errors

- Learners may overgeneralize the first pattern they notice. Keep returning to **Key Points** and ask students to explain what changes from one example to the next.
- Long explanations can hide the signal word or structure. Have students underline the exact phrase that tells them which form, pattern, or response is needed.
- If students can choose an answer but cannot explain it, ask them to justify their choice using words taken directly from the concept sheet.

Differentiation and Delivery Notes

- Support: teach one section at a time, then send students back to **the examples** or the practice set so they can apply the same rule immediately.
- Pair work: let students compare answers aloud before you reveal the key. The explanation step is as important as the final answer.
- Extension: ask stronger students to write two fresh examples or a short dialogue that uses the same target language accurately.

Model Language from the Concept Sheet

- "The company experienced a sharp increase in customer inquiries following the product launch." Explanation: Here, "sharp increase" implies that the number of customer inquiries rose quickly and by a large margin, emphasizing the impact of the product launch.
- "There has been a slight fall in the stock prices after the earnings report." Explanation: In this context, "slight fall" suggests that the stock prices decreased, but the change was minimal, potentially indicating market stability despite the earnings report.
- "Sales figures sharply increased in response to the new marketing campaign." Explanation: The adverb "sharply" conveys the idea that the sales figures did not just increase, but did so in a manner that was both sudden and significant, underscoring the effectiveness of the campaign.
- "The unemployment rate has fallen slightly over the past month." Explanation: "Fallen slightly" indicates that while there was a decrease in unemployment, the change was minor, hinting at a stable labor market.
- Dramatic / Dramatically: Usage: These terms are used to describe very large or sudden changes....
- Slight / Slightly: Usage: These terms indicate a small or minor change....



Answer Key

Use this key for whole-class feedback or fast marking.

ITEM 01

The company experienced a dramatic increase in profits last quarter.

ITEM 02

The stock prices Correct after the announcement.

ITEM 03

There has been a Correct decrease in sales recently.

ITEM 04

The company's performance has Correct slightly after the restructuring.

ITEM 05

The temperature has Correct steadily over the past week.

ITEM 06

Sales have Correct slightly since the start of the year.

ITEM 07

The number of visitors Correct significantly after the new exhibit opened.

ITEM 08

The market Correct fluctuating due to uncertainty in global trade.

ITEM 09

After the initial drop, sales Correct to their previous levels.

ITEM 10

The stock market has been Correct throughout the year.

ITEM 11

The unemployment rate has Correct slightly over the past month.

ITEM 12

The number of tourists Correct during the pandemic but recovered afterward.

ITEM 13

There was a Correct in cases after the vaccine rollout.

ITEM 14

The economy Correct slowly after the recession.



ITEM 15

The prices have been Correct due to market instability.

ITEM 16

The situation has Correct to improve, but it remains uncertain.

ITEM 17

The sales numbers have Correct significantly in recent months.

ITEM 18

The prices Correct slowly after the market crash.

ITEM 19

There has been a Correct drop in consumer confidence this year.

ITEM 20

The economic indicators have been Correct steadily this quarter.

ITEM 21

The project deadlines have Correct closer as the year progresses.

ITEM 22

The market Correct fluctuating lately, and investors are concerned.

ITEM 23

The unemployment rate Correct slightly, indicating a stable economy.

ITEM 24

The company has been Correct significantly in recent years.

Feedback Cues

- Item 01: Answer: a) dramatic
- Item 02: Answer: a) rose
- Item 03: Answer: c) significant
- Item 04: Answer: b) improved
- Item 05: Answer: b) risen
- Item 06: Answer: b) decreased